



FIFA projected

\$80 BILLION

in economic impact.

80%

US hotels
below forecast

\$1B+

Canada's bill
13 matches

180K

tickets unsold
before kick-off



RYAD BENZAIM 
Data analyst

The beautiful game. The complicated economics.

WHAT FIFA PROMISED

2 / 8

\$80.1B

**Gross economic output
(WTO estimate for 3 countries)**

\$30.5B

**For the US economy alone
(Infantino, CNBC, 2025)**

\$8.9B

**FIFA's own revenue target
(2023–2026 commercial cycle)**

200,000

**Permanent jobs promised
in the United States**

CANADA'S BUDGET EXPLOSION

3 / 8

Jan 2023

\$230M

Initial estimate
(5 games)

Jun 2025

\$624M

Updated estimate
(7 games)

2026

\$729M+

Final projection
(Mercury News)

TOTAL CANADA (13 matches) :

\$1.066B

"They demand, you deliver. Take it or leave it."

- Romain Schué, Radio-Canada Enquête (Mar 2026)

US HOTELS: THE WINDFALL THAT WASN'T

4 / 8

80%

of US host city hotels
below initial booking forecasts

Kansas City

~90%

below Jun/Jul baseline

Dallas & Houston

70%

hoteliers below expectations

New York / NJ

~15%

Final city — best performer

**Why? FIFA cancelled ~70% of reserved room blocks → inflated early signals.
International visitors skewed to Mexico & Canada markets.
Domestic, last-minute, price-sensitive demand replaced the expected global wave.**

THE TICKET PRICE SCANDAL



WHO REALLY WINS?

6 / 8

✓ WINNERS

FIFA \$8.9B — record revenue cycle

Broadcasters \$3.92B rights — +30% vs Qatar 2022

Sponsors \$2.4B — sold out inventory

NY/NJ Final \$800M+ estimated impact

MLS & US Soccer Long-term brand lift

✗ LOSERS

Taxpayers \$1B+ in Canada alone (PBO)

Host cities Security + infra, no revenue

Local hotels 80% below forecast

Fans Final +273% vs bid promise

Cultural events Cancelled by FIFA order

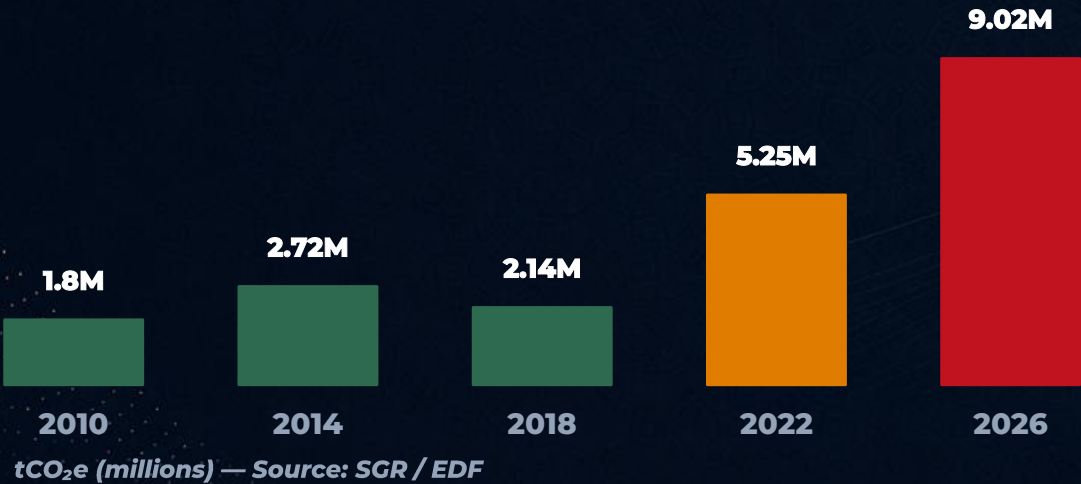
"A lot of people will make a lot of money. But it won't be the taxpayers." — Josh Matlow, Toronto City Councillor

THE CLIMATE COST

9.02M

tons CO₂e

Most polluting World Cup ever



x2 vs average
2010–2022 editions

85% of emissions
from air travel

6.5M cars driven
for a full year

+30M tCO₂e additional
induced by FIFA–Aramco sponsorship
deal
(estimated increased fossil fuel sales)

"FIFA must take responsibility for its growing role in the climate crisis."
- Dr Stuart Parkinson, Scientists for Global Responsibility (SGR), 2025

The beautiful game.

The complicated economics.

01

**FIFA profits are
locked in.
Host city gains are
not.**

02

**Budgets always
escalate.
×3 in Vancouver.**

03

**11 of 14 World Cups
ran
deficits for the host.**

Sources: Radio-Canada • FIFA/WTO • PBO • AHLA • Front Office Sports • The Conversation



RYAD BENZAIM 
Data analyst

**Follow for more
projects & analysis**